THE PRICE OF DAWN — D100 TWILIGHT CHARACTER QUESTIONS

Varenhold Grounding Table · Roll 1d100 for memories, sensory stakes & moral weight

I. THE LOST SUN & AMBER ATMOSPHERE (01–10)

01. **[SUN]** You've never felt direct sunlight. What was the wildest thing an elder told you the sun could do?

02. **[BLUE]** When someone says "blue," what shade actually appears in your mind's eye?

03. **[WARMTH]** What is the warmest natural thing you've touched that didn't come from an amber furnace?

04. **[WONDER]** Have you stared directly into an amber lamp until your vision flashed? What did you hope to see?

05. **[DREAMS]** The sky is slate-grey. What is the most vivid dream of a clear sky you've ever had?

06. **[BLIGHT]** When did you first realize plants outside the city grow pale and stunted without real daybreak?

07. **[FOLKLORE]** An old song describes "shadows that vanish at noon." How does a disappearing shadow make you feel?

08. **[ART]** In pre-Twilight tapestries, what color looked most unnatural or frightening to you?

09. **[MORNING]** What scent means "morning" to you, since daybreak is only marked by bells and coal smoke?

10. **[PRICE]** If promised five minutes of genuine, blazing midday sun, what would you trade for it?

II. DAILY SURVIVAL & THE COLD REALITY (11–20)

11. **[OMEN]** What small superstition do you observe whenever an amber streetlamp flickers?

12. **[FOOD]** Your go-to comfort food: salted cap-mushrooms, tallow bread, river eel, or chicory brew?

13. **[TIME]** How do you tell day from night when your clock is exhausted and the sky never changes?

14. **[FOG]** Which garment of yours is permanently damp at the cuffs from river fog?

15. **[WAKING]** What sound wakes you: Lowmark coal carts, cathedral bells, or Reckoning patrol boots?

16. **[RELIC]** You fiddle with a pocket token when anxious. What is it, and who gave it to you?

17. **[TAVERN]** Favorite hole-in-the-wall tavern where the hearthfire is actually kept warm?

18. **[HIDING]** Where in Varenhold do you go to be totally alone, where not even orphans find you?

19. **[CHILL]** How many layers of wool or leather do you wear daily to keep frost from your joints?

20. **[WARMTH]** Most expensive thing you bought this year purely to keep from freezing?

III. SICKNESS, FROST & THE HEALERS (21–30)

21. **[GRIEF]** Who was the first person you watched develop the chalky cough of Stage-1 Grey Sickness?

22. **[REMEDY]** What foul tincture or herbal brew does your family swear keeps the ash out of lungs?

23. **[TERROR]** When you cough at dawn, do you secretly check your handkerchief for ash before pocketing it?

24. **[CLINIC]** Ever entered the Lowmark Healing House? What smell hit you first inside?

25. **[WINTER]** Coldest night of your life: who or what kept you from freezing in your sleep?

26. **[QUARANTINE]** If a close friend hid a Stage-2 tremor, would you report them or shelter them?

27. **[RHYMES]** Cruelest joke or rhyme street children sing about people turning ash-grey?

28. **[DAWNBORN]** Ever stood near a Dawnborn and felt the air heat up? What went through your mind?

29. **[SCARS]** Which old scar or bone ache flares worst whenever northern frost rolls in?

30. **[DRAUGHT]** If a potion guaranteed frost immunity for 3 months' rations, would you buy it?

IV. AMBER ECONOMY & FUEL (31–40)

31. **[CHITS]** How many amber ration chits do you currently have sewn into your coat lining?

32. **[LIES]** Cleverest lie you told a quartermaster to get an extra measure of fuel or grain?

33. **[THEFT]** Ever stolen an amber bead from a lamp or shrine? Did you keep it or sell it?

34. **[WASTE]** What pre-Twilight luxury seems utterly ridiculous and wasteful to you now?

35. **[SMUGGLE]** The Compact taxes amber glass. Ever helped someone smuggle glass across canals?

36. **[DEBT]** What item did you inherit from someone who couldn't pay their Compact heating debt?

37. **[FORTUNE]** With 100 gold: buy land outside walls, hoard amber crystals, or hire a carriage out?

38. **[ALLIES]** Which merchant knows your name and cuts you a break when times are tight?

39. **[DIGNITY]** Lowest price you've seen someone sell their pride for during a bread famine?

40. **[LANTERN]** Have you ever owned your own amber lamp, or always had to borrow light?

V. CITY QUARTERS, STREETS & SHADOWS (41–50)

41. **[DREAD]** Which district makes your neck hairs rise when walking it after fourth bell?

42. **[ALLEY]** Favorite Ashring shortcut through back alleys that the city watch doesn't know?

43. **[SPIRE]** Looked up at the Spire catwalks: what do you think astronomers are hiding up there?

44. **[TUNNELS]** What rumor about the subterranean tunnels beneath canal locks do you half-believe?

45. **[BRAWLS]** In which tavern was your first bar brawl, and what petty argument sparked it?

46. **[HOME]** Which neighborhood felt like home when you were young, and how has it decayed?

47. **[GRANITE]** Oldest piece of pre-Twilight stone architecture you pass daily without noticing?

48. **[GATES]** If gates barred for permanent quarantine tomorrow: caught inside or outside?

49. **[BEAUTY]** Most beautiful sight you've seen in Varenhold despite the perpetual gloom?

50. **[SAGES]** Which beggar or street character do you toss coin to, and what story do they tell?

VI. FACTIONS & DIVIDED LOYALTIES (51–60)

51. **[PATROL]** Your closest call with a Reckoning patrol demanding papers or inspection?

52. **[HARRAN]** Is Harran Lecht a tyrant trying to enslave the city, or a desperate man holding back the dark?

53. **[VIGILS]** Ever attended Brother Edoran's midnight lantern vigils? Did you feel holy or uneasy?

54. **[DAWNLESS]** The Dawnless are silent. What rumor about their severed names scares you most?

55. **[BLADES]** If Solennite Blades offered coin to spy on companions, would you refuse or hesitate?

56. **[DIVIDED]** What friend or kin joined the Reckoning, and can you still look them in the eye?

57. **[ROT]** Most corrupt act by a Councillor or Guildmaster you witnessed in broad daylight?

58. **[SHADAR-KAI]** Ever caught the gaze of Concordance priests watching from dark alleys?

59. **[ZEALOTS]** Which faction is most dangerous because they genuinely believe they are the heroes?

60. **[ALLIANCE]** Who do you trust with your life: Ostenveld, Harran Lecht, or Brother Edoran?

VII. FAITH, GODS & PRAYERS (61–70)

61. **[PRAYERS]** Praying in the dark: Auris the Wounded Sun, Solenne of the Hearth, or forgotten gods?

62. **[SILENCE]** Did the gods abandon Varenhold for Corven's sin, or were they powerless to stop it?

63. **[CHARMS]** What holy symbol or consecrated token do you carry, and where did you get it?

64. **[BLASPHEMY]** Most blasphemous thought about the sun god while shivering by an amber lamp?

65. **[CATHEDRAL]** Ever lit a taper in Auris Cathedral watching wax drip on cold stone? What did you pray for?

66. **[PULPIT]** When priests promise "radiant dawn for the righteous," do you feel comforted or bitter?

67. **[AFTERLIFE]** Do souls who die under twilight reach the afterlife, or wander the cold mist?

68. **[FESTIVAL]** What seasonal festival do you still keep, even though astronomical seasons are gone?

69. **[SHRINES]** Strangest wayside shrine you've encountered out in Ashfen marsh or Dusk Parishes?

70. **[DEMAND]** Facing Auris directly: what angry or desperate question would you demand answered?

VIII. FAMILY, MEMORY & CHILDHOOD (71–80)

71. **[GAMES]** Childhood street game that required hiding in deep shadow between lamp pools?

72. **[ORCHARDS]** Which elder wouldn't stop raving about how green apples were before Year of Ash?

73. **[SHIELDS]** What did parents try to shield you from that you discovered anyway before twelve?

74. **[LOST KIN]** Childhood friend who vanished to sickness, moved away, or joined a hated faction?

75. **[LIES]** First lie your parents told you about twilight so you wouldn't fear the dark?

76. **[KEEPSAKE]** What possession of your mother or father do you still carry everywhere?

77. **[HEARTH]** Grew up with ample coal, or in a drafty tenement sleeping with all clothes on?

78. **[SILENCE]** Last thing you said to someone in your family before bitter silence fell?

79. **[LESSONS]** What lesson drilled by a mentor has kept you alive when others died?

80. **[JOY]** When did you last laugh until ribs hurt, and who was in the room with you?

IX. MORAL COMPROMISE & GUILT (81–90)

81. **[CRIME]** Worst thing you did to ensure you or a loved one had fuel or food for winter?

82. **[SCALE]** Sacrifice one innocent to restore sun to 300,000: where does your gut land?

83. **[PAST]** A secret about your history you pray your party companions never uncover?

84. **[OATHS]** Have you broken a solemn oath because keeping it would have ruined you?

85. **[FAILURE]** Who is the person you secretly believe you failed when they needed you most?

86. **[TRUST]** Which party member do you trust unconditionally to pull you from fire?

87. **[BURDENS]** Which companion do you fear is carrying a secret burden that will snap them?

88. **[THE LINE]** What moral line will you never cross, no matter how desperate the stakes?

89. **[CONSCIENCE]** Killing an enemy in the dark: what do you tell yourself to wash your conscience?

90. **[UNSAID]** If you died tonight in the Ashring, what would you regret leaving unsaid?

X. DAWNBORN, SACRIFICE & CLIMAX (91–100)

91. **[DAWNBORN]** Ten people carrying the trapped dawn in their blood: do you envy or pity them?

92. **[TOMAS]** Tomas Areth obsessively checking star notes for 40 years: what would you say to him?

93. **[ALDRIC]** Aldric Stone's glowing amber eyes: does being near genuine heat unnerve you?

94. **[FREE WILL]** A Dawnborn says: "I don't want to die for your city." Could you force them on the stone?

95. **[DAY AFTER]** The day after sun returns: will people dance in streets, or turn on each other?

96. **[ECONOMY]** Amber guilds lose everything overnight when sun returns. Whose ruin can you watch?

97. **[PEACE]** What will you do with your life if you no longer fight to survive every day?

98. **[FEAR OF DAWN]** Most terrifying thing about real sun: afraid you won't recognize yourself in light?

99. **[IXA]** Ixa's hands are always warm. What part of her survival echoes your own?

100. **[THE PRICE]** If dawn has a price, and someone in this room must pay it... why not you?